

Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

2024 Stack Overflow Developer Survey

65,437 respondents across 180+ countries

Source: survey.stackoverflow.co/2024

84% of Developers Are Working, but Full-Time Employment Dips in the U.S.

GLOBAL BREAKDOWN

69%

Full-time employed

16.4%

Freelance / Contract

13.2%

Full-time students

U.S. TREND

Full-time employment dropped



-4.2 percentage points YoY

In the U.K. and Ukraine, non-full-time respondents lean toward independent contracting; in Germany and India, toward full-time students.

In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%

WORK ARRANGEMENT DISTRIBUTION (2024)

42%

Hybrid

Most common, consistent with 2023

38%

Remote

Second most common arrangement

20%

In-Person

Rising for 3rd consecutive year

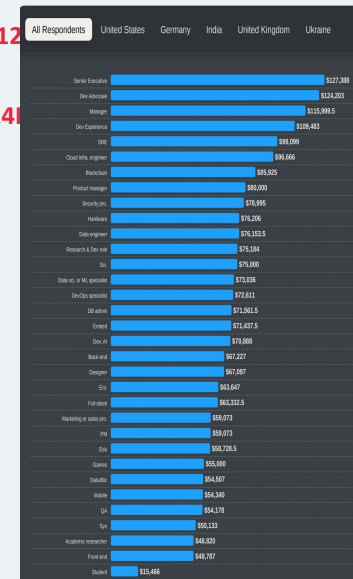
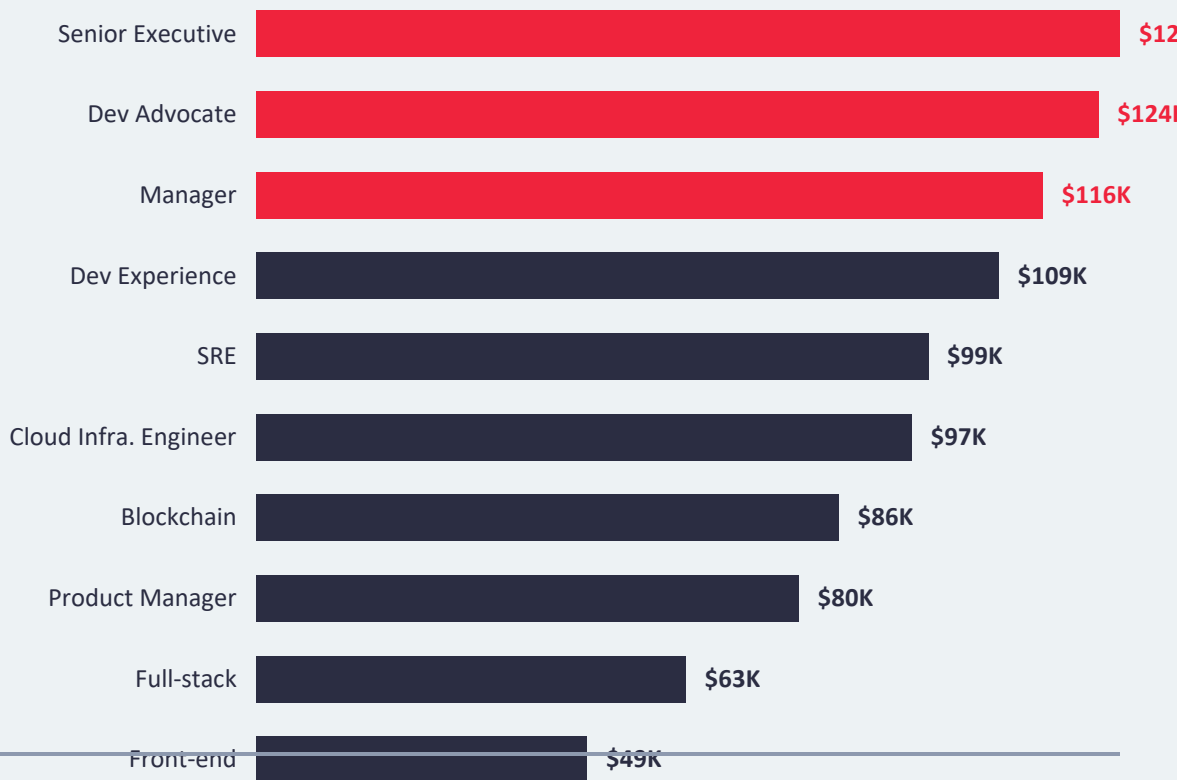
IN-PERSON TREND (3-YEAR)



Signals a gradual return-to-office trend across the industry

Source: 2024 Stack Overflow Developer Survey

Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median Salary



22,677 salary responses (34.7% response rate) | SRE and Cloud Infra are highest-paid purely technical roles

Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-Figure Salaries

KEY OBSERVATIONS

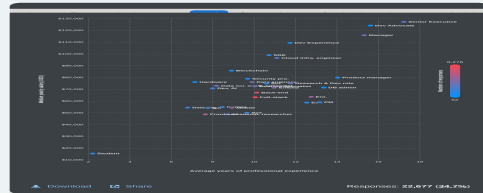
Senior Exec: \$127K / 17 yrs

Dev Advocate: \$124K / 16 yrs

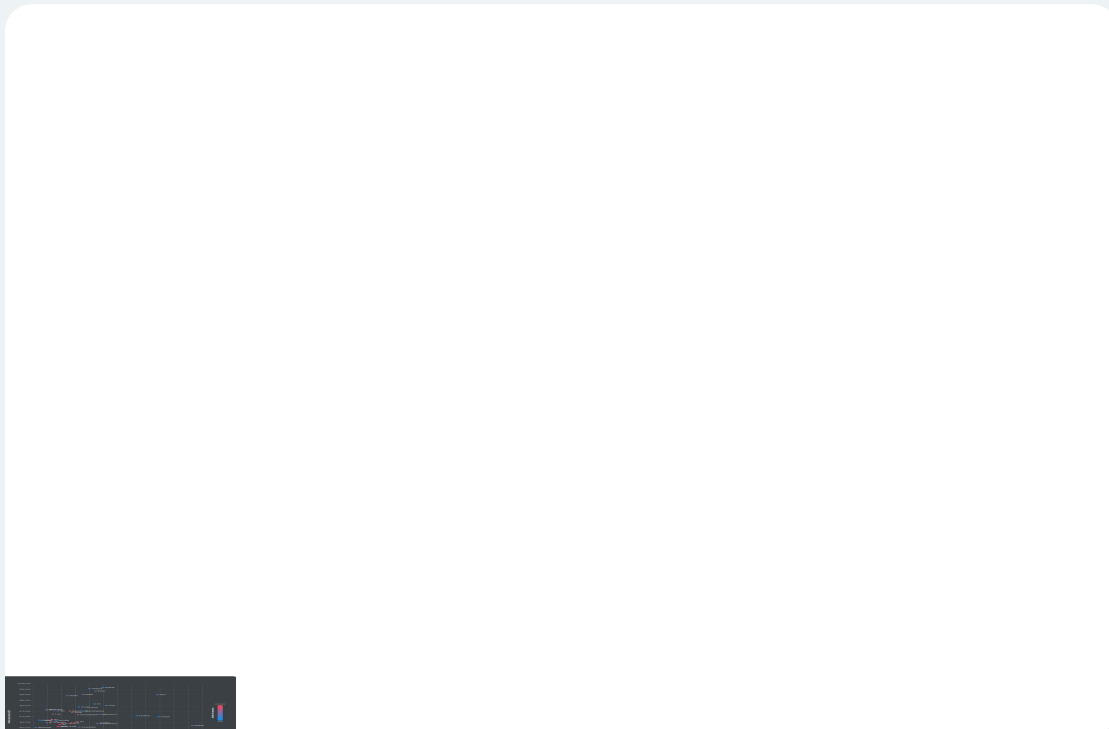
Manager: \$116K / 15 yrs

Student outlier: \$15K / 2 yrs

SRE: \$99K / 10 yrs (best \$/yr ratio for technical roles)



Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog Below \$45K



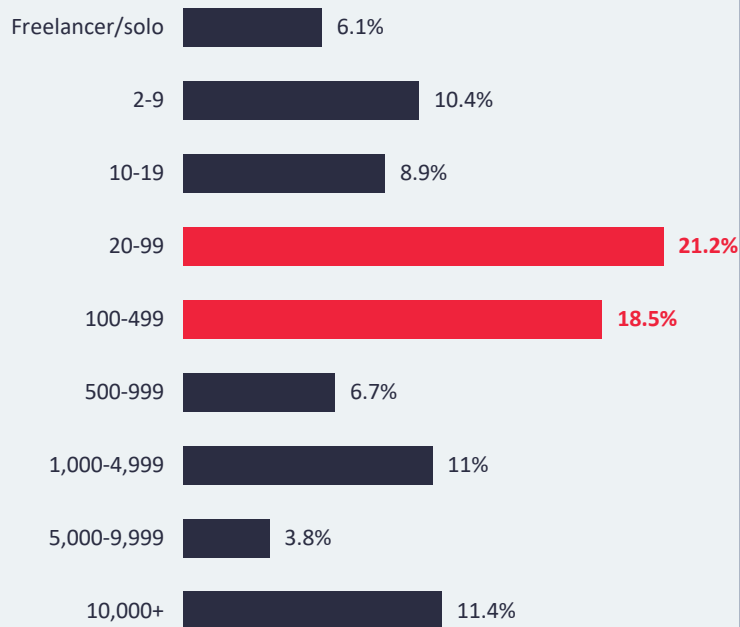
SALARY RANKING BY LANGUAGE

Erlang	\$97K	12 yrs
Clojure	\$95K	11 yrs
Elixir	\$93K	11 yrs
Perl	\$90K	19 yrs
Ruby	\$89K	11 yrs
Scala	\$88K	9 yrs
Go	\$76K	9 yrs
Python	\$67K	9 yrs
JavaScript	\$64K	10 yrs
PHP	\$49K	10 yrs
Dart	\$44K	8 yrs
Prolog	\$43K	9 yrs

Overall salary range dropped ~\$10K vs. 2023 (now \$60-75K avg vs. \$70-85K prior year)

47% Work at Sub-100 Orgs; 62% Influence Tech Purchases

COMPANY SIZE DISTRIBUTION



n = 42,827 respondents

TECHNOLOGY PURCHASING INFLUENCE

62%

of developers influence tech purchases

INFLUENCE BY ROLE

Senior Executives	99%
Engineering Managers	87%
Product Managers	77%

HOW DEVELOPERS EVALUATE TOOLS

- 75% start a free trial
- 73% ask other developers
- 60% prefer build-and-buy approach

Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

01 Plan for more contractors

Full-time employment is softening (U.S. dropped 4pp YoY). Build workforce models that accommodate 16%+ freelancers and contractors.

02 Hybrid remains dominant, but in-person is growing

In-person mandates now at 20% (up from 15% in 2022). Hybrid at 42% is still the norm — forced RTO risks attrition.

03 DevRel and SRE roles command premium pay

Dev Advocates (\$124K) and SREs (\$99K) reflect market scarcity. Budget accordingly for these hard-to-fill roles.

04 Language choice correlates with compensation

Niche functional languages (Erlang, Clojure, Elixir) pay >\$93K median. Mainstream (JS, PHP) sit below \$65K.

05 Engage developers directly in purchasing

62% of developers influence tech purchases. Vendor strategies should target ICs, not just management — trials and peer reviews